University of Basel

Research Data Management
Network

Don’t ghost your data or it will haunt you

Call for Proposals: Data Curation Conference, January 14, 2027

A cross-disciplinary conference on research data curation, (re)usability, and AI

Good data outlives the project it was born in. Bad data haunts it. Somewhere between those two fates sits the daily, unglamorous, surprisingly hard work of data curation—and that is what this conference is about.

High-quality data is the cornerstone of open and trustworthy research, yet keeping it valuable, durable, and usable is never a one-and-done task. The moment we try to store or publish data; the tricky questions arrive:

- Is the documentation good enough for someone else—or future you—to actually reuse it?
- Is this format going to be readable in ten years? Is the metadata complete?
- Where does AI genuinely help in automating and enriching curation, and where does it quietly complicate things?
- And how can sensitive data be curated to enable safe sharing and future reuse?

Every day, more datasets slip quietly into the shadows of forgotten drives and undocumented folders—and with funders and journals demanding FAIR, curated, shareable data, the skeletons in our digital closets are getting harder to ignore.

With this **conference**, the Research Data Management Network of the University of Basel aims to provide **a space for researchers and data specialists at the university to share experiences, tools, and hard-won lessons**—covering the technical solutions as well as the human, organizational, and ethical dimensions of managing and publishing research data in a fast-changing world.

The conference will take place at the **University of Basel** and is conceived as a platform for **open exchange** and an **opportunity to learn from one another** in order to improve data quality, daily research practices, and research outcomes.

Share with us your experiences and practices for organizing, versioning, documenting, and enriching your research data with metadata—and making it more FAIR—as you prepare to publish them. Tell us about the (AI) tools and techniques you use for this, what has proven useful, and where you’ve encountered challenges. Off-the-cuff topics and outside-the-box thinking are welcome.

We look forward to your contributions and curating a great day together!

Submission formats

Whatever shape your contribution takes, there’s a slot for it:

- **Lightning talk (3min):** a short, punchy use-case from your own work. High energy, low slide-count. Perfect for sharing and discussing one idea that worked (or didn’t).
- **Classical presentation (10min):** a more traditional, in-depth talk for those who want to walk the audience through their experiences at greater length.
- **Workshop session (30–50min):** a hands-on, interactive slot to introduce your questions, concerns, preferred tools, or best practices and think them through together with the room.

This is important: **we are not asking for finished, polished solutions**. Half-solved problems, productive dead-ends, nagging concerns, and “here’s what’s keeping me up at night” contributions are not just welcome—they are often the most useful thing in the room. Bring your questions and difficulties. Someone else has probably wrestled with them too.

How to submit

Send us a *short abstract* with a *title* (**max. 350 words**) outlining the *topic(s)* of your lightning talk, presentation, or workshop. Please specify your *discipline*, your *use-case* and the *data curation aspect(s)* you intend to focus on. We will notify you of the acceptance of your submission by November 15.

Submission to researchdata@unibas.ch with the subject line "**Submission DCC**".

~~**Deadline for submissions: September 30, 2026**~~

Extended deadline for submissions: October 21, 2026

About the conference

The conference is organized by the Research Data Management Network of the University of Basel, whose goal is to provide the university's researchers with the best possible research data management (RDM) support by bringing together data stewards, infrastructure providers, and service providers in a university-wide network. The event marks the conclusion of a two-year project phase on research data workflows and research data curation. Find more information about the RDM Network and the conference on our website: https://researchdata.unibas.ch/en/services/data-curation-conference-2027/

Location

University of Basel

Language

The conference language will be English.

Open Access Policy

By submitting a proposal, you agree that your presentation will be made online available on Zenodo under an open license. The expected licenses are Creative Commons Attribution (CC BY 4.0 or CC BY-SA 4.0).

Code of Conduct

We are committed to a respectful and inclusive environment. The University of Basel's Code of Conduct applies.